

AI-Native Operating Systems & Executive Execution Leader

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania | 412.287.8640 | russelldudek@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/russelldudek

<https://russelldudek.github.io/ClickUp/>

Interview Thesis Brief

Preserve founder frequency. Eliminate organizational drag.

A role-specific point of view for building an AI-native CEO office that makes the CEO faster, the leadership team more coherent, and strategic priorities more likely to ship.

Actual Work

Create a CEO-office operating system that preserves Zeb's product and customer depth, turns high priority velocity into owned decisions and delivery, rewires functions around agents and irreplaceable human judgment, and makes the AI-era company narrative board-grade.

Company Moment

Convergence is the product thesis ClickUp is unifying work surfaces and AI around shared context. Internal operations must demonstrate the same coherence.	The 100x org raises the proof burden Higher leverage must become observable workflow redesign, stronger authority boundaries, and measured outcomes.
Founder depth is an advantage The goal is not to push the CEO away from product detail; it is to build an intelligence layer that makes depth scalable.	Pre-IPO narrative must be operational Board and investor materials need one defensible story connecting growth, product, AI leverage, people, risk, and execution.

Operating Tensions

Founder detail / scalable attention	Agent speed / human authority	Priority volume / closure
Reinvention / trust	Product depth / org whiplash	Founder speed / governance

Candidate Thesis

Founder speed becomes company speed only when priorities close cleanly. The CEO office should operate as a closure system: every priority resolves through Intent, Decision, Work split, Delivery, and Evidence. Agents carry repeatable context work; humans retain judgment, tradeoffs, relationships, irreversible commitments, and exception authority.

Executive Commit

Intent	What changes, why now, and what is outside scope?
Decision	What tradeoff is made, by whom, and what reopens it?
Work split	What is agent-default, human-required, and escalation-triggered?
Delivery	Who owns the outcome, dependencies, and definition of shipped?
Evidence	What outcome, adoption, quality, risk, and learning determine the next decision?

Verified Proof Map

AI-native operating transformation Vape-Jet: direct work across production, purchasing, quality, support, engineering issue flow, ERP, CRM, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.	Agentic work design DudeWorth: structured context, retrieval, agents, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, governance, adoption, and time-to-value.
High-volume operating cadence Amazon: Prime Pittsburgh launch and execution in a 24/7 environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.	High-consequence integration Compunetics: engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, process controls, and programs involving DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.

Strongest Plausible Hiring Concern

Russell has not held the formal title of Chief of Staff to a founder-CEO at a 1,000-person pre-IPO SaaS company. The credible response is not title substitution. It is a working AI-native CEO-office mechanism, verified operating evidence across complex systems and launches, an explicit 90-day de-risking sequence, and a live demonstration of how he uses AI to make decisions and execution legible.

First 90 Days

- 0-15: read CEO frequency, map cadence and attention, baseline decision latency and priority closure.
- 16-30: launch Daily CEO Brief v1, Executive Commit v1, and decision-centered weekly leadership rhythm.
- 31-45: use one consequential cross-functional priority to prove closure and attention architecture.
- 46-60: launch one bounded first-principles functional redesign with authority, auditability, rollback, and adoption ownership.
- 61-75: put board preparation on rails with definitions, actions, issue log, narrative owner, review path, and dry run.
- 76-90: publish the CEO-office operating contract and select the next redesigns based on evidence and leader readiness.

Executive Interview Questions

- Which details repeatedly require Zeb's personal repair because the system does not preserve context or judgment?
- Where has AI already removed real work, and where has it mainly increased content volume?
- What would the leadership team say is the most expensive form of ambiguity today?
- Which three priorities most often diffuse between CEO intent and a shipped result?
- What board narrative is hardest to make operationally undeniable?
- Where should this role challenge Zeb directly, and what evidence earns that right?

Balanced Success Measures

Dimension	Measure category
CEO leverage	Decision-ready context, preparation burden, repeated questions, time allocation
Execution	Decision latency, blocker age, priority closure, shipped or stopped outcomes
Transformation	Work eliminated, agent-owned work, cycle time, rework, quality, adoption
Leadership	Decision ownership, unresolved misalignment, meeting-to-action conversion
Governance	Board action closure, definition integrity, review readiness, issue visibility
Learning	Time from shipped evidence to changed operating decision